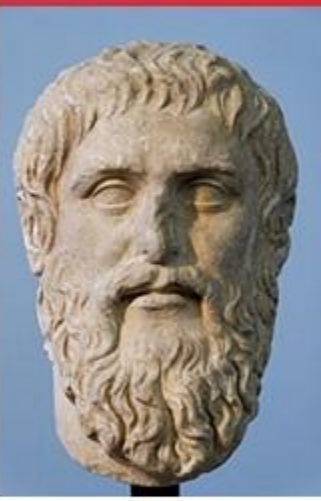
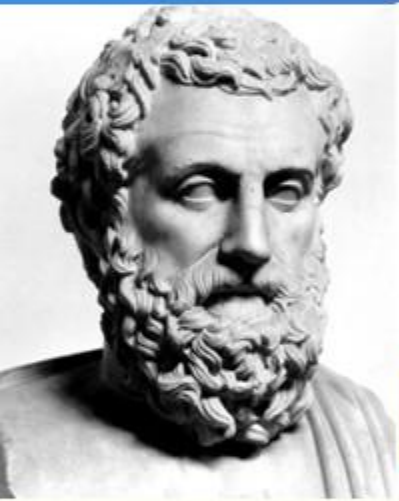


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



MODULE - 7

**ETHICS IN PRIVATE AND
PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS**

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

CASE OF BILL CLINTON



One of the most liked and approved Presidents of the United States of America of the modern era, **Bill Clinton** was the 42nd President and was in power for the constitutionally stipulated maximum period of 8 years from 1993 to 2001.



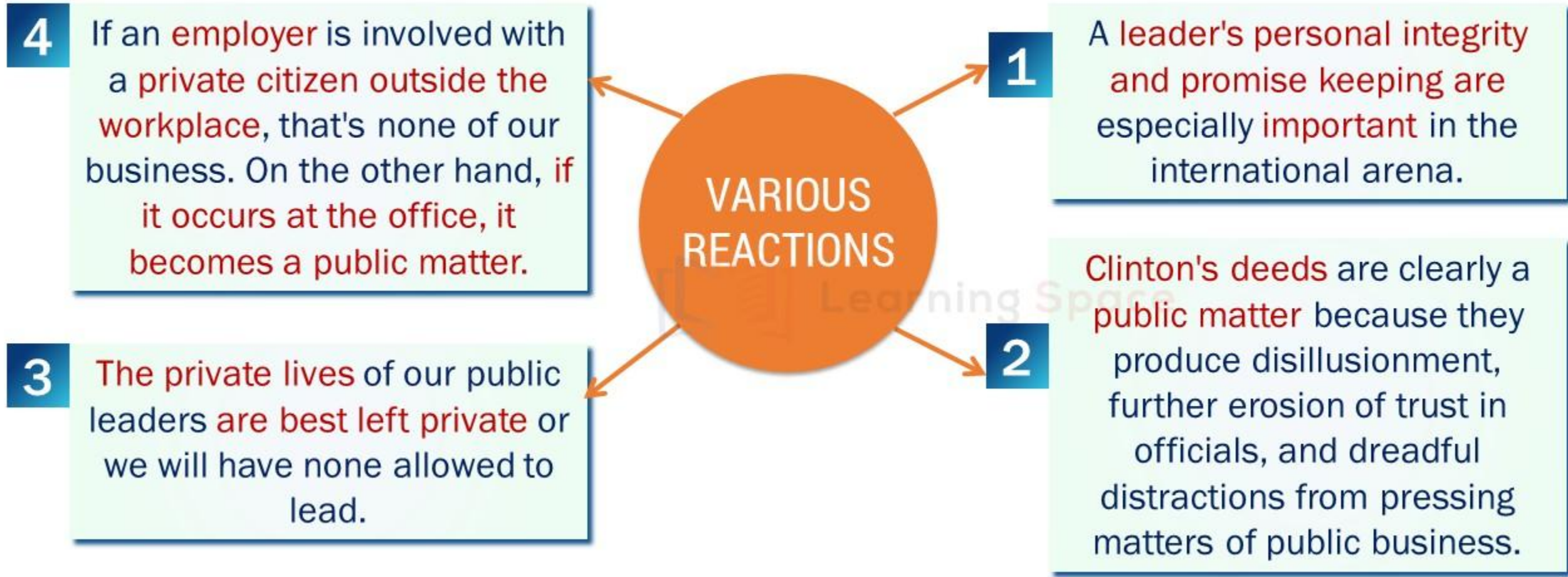
Allegation of sexual misconduct and the Monica Lewinsky affair surfaced, leading to his impeachment by the house in 1998 but the senate later acquitted him in 1999.



He **continued to be the president** until his term ended in 2001. Post his president ship, several polls indicated that people missed him for his leadership skills

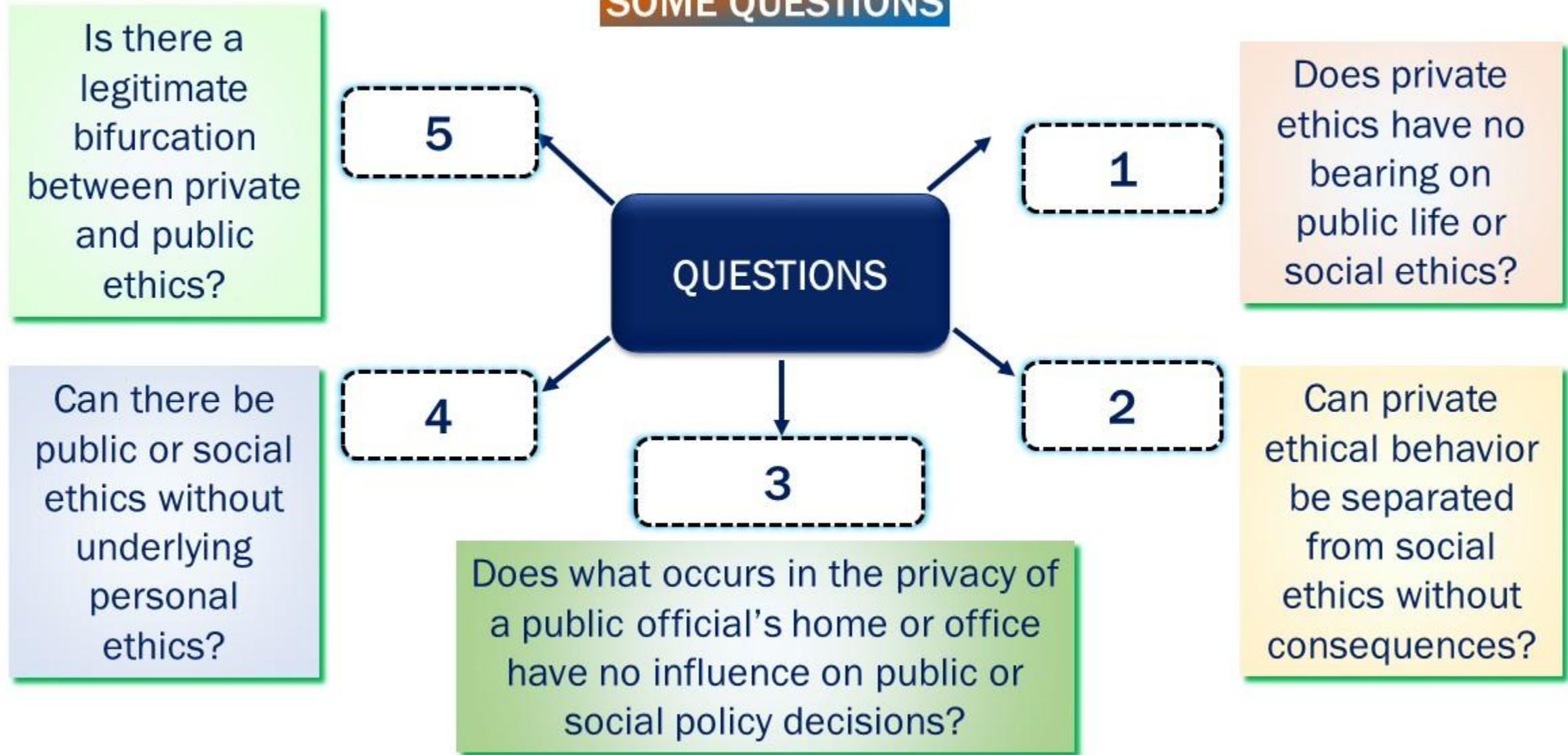
Did his lack of personal ethics make him an incompetent or unethical leader?

REACTIONS



What do you think?

SOME QUESTIONS



These questions deal with law, morality, relationships development, the inner life and its outward expression, and public and social policy development.

MORE EXAMPLES



- ✓ Narendra Modi's choice of his marital status was not an electoral issue and people judged him only on his leadership skills.
- ✓ Rahul Gandhi's bachelorhood doesn't make him any less competent as a leader in the opinion of the electorate.
- ✓ Atal Bihari Vajpayee was a bachelor and his personal choices didn't prevent him from being one of the most liked Prime Ministers.
- ✓ Mahatma Gandhi, father of the nation, is still revered despite his perceived failure as the father of his son Harilal.

MORE EXAMPLES



Keshab Chandra Sen

- ✓ Cricketers **K L Rahul** and **Hardik Pandya** were dropped from the Indian team for their inappropriate comments made on popular television programme.
- ✓ **M J Akbar** was forced to resign as a Minister owing to the sexual harassment allegations made against him.
- ✓ Followers of **Keshab Chandra Sen**, the founder of Brahmo Samaj of India, who opposed child marriage but married his own underage daughter to Maharaja of Cooch Bihar, abandoned him and founded Sadharan Brahmo Samaj.



PRIVATE ROLE



PUBLIC ROLE

We, human beings play different roles—in both **private and public capacity**—in life, and these roles define our relations with others.

The **private roles** we play such as father, mother, husband, son, daughter, grandson or friend define the relationships such as family, marriage or friendship.

The **public roles** we play such as student, employer, worker, lawyer or leader define the relationships such as teacher — student, lawyer — client or leader—follower.

*Even **private relationships** have two versions: the **private version** and the **public version**.*



Each private relationship has its own set of expectations and norms — both implicit and explicit.

Individual familial and community obligations have been codified for a long time and supported by serious sanctions from ancient time to today's inheritance divorce, marriage and other laws.

Individual virtues, religious and social norms and laws, and community relationships serve as the basis for ethics in private relationships.

In India, along with moral codes, religious institutions and constitutional provisions govern ethical issues in private relationship.

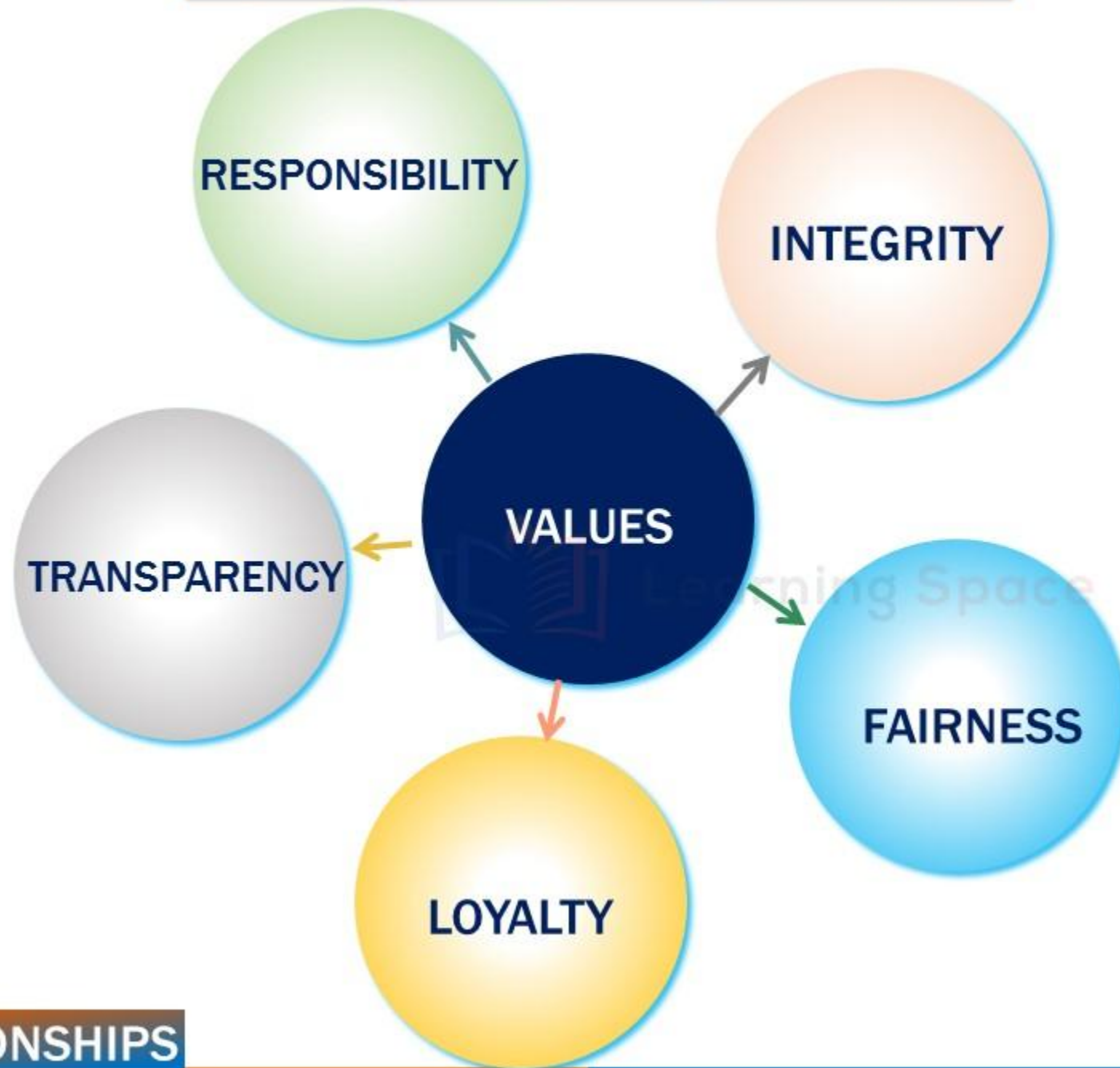


Public relationships usually comprise of **conflict of interest and role, complex situations and contradictory values.**

As ethics in public relationship are usually governed by power, it is **important to follow ethical standard in public setting** to sustain authority, develop confidence among people about the system, and to accomplish social wellbeing of society.

Integrity is important not only because it is necessary to **build self-confidence** but also because it ensures **professional survival.**





DIFFERENCES

PRIVATE RELATIONSHIPS:

- ✓ They are mostly, but not always, **inherited without a choice**.
- ✓ Generally these relationships **are long lasting** and **imperfections and failures are excused**.
- ✓ We **deal with** people having some sort of **similarity in value system** with us.
- ✓ Our private relationships exist **with limited number of people**.
- ✓ Objectives are **affection, intimacy, loyalty and love**.
- ✓ The **duties** are either **voluntary** or imposed by **personal or religious laws**.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS:

- ✓ They **can be chosen** but sometimes they are inherited without choice.
- ✓ **Imperfections and failures may not be tolerated** and may terminate the relationship.
- ✓ **No control over the temperament** of the people we deal with.
- ✓ Public relationships exist with **vast or indeterminate number of people**.
- ✓ Objectives are **material gains, power, respect, attention or authority**.
- ✓ The **duties** are **externally defined and imposed** by codes or laws.



Public could include shareholders, government, consumers, employees and the media.

Public Relation is a management function that engages monitoring and evaluating public attitudes and maintaining mutual relations and understanding between an organization and its **public**.

Public relation officers **guarantee internal unity** in the company by **maintaining a clear communications network** between the management and personnel.

Its **major objective** is to improve channels of communication and to **establish** new ways of setting up a **two-way flow of information and understanding**.

Public relationships are not same as **public relations** employed by an organisation or administration.



The goals of professional standards for the practice of PR are:

- To provide behavioural guidelines to its members.
- To educate management on public relations standards.
- To distinguish public relations professionals from those individuals

Ethics codes are still not widespread, because it cannot be expected that everyone, regardless of the situation and culture, abides by the same moral standards.

It can be difficult to balance the interests of the public with the interests of the organization itself.

Public Relations Society of America's (PRSA) code of ethics prescribes Advocacy, Honesty, Expertise, Independence, Loyalty and Fairness as the major guiding principles.

CONFLICT OF INTEREST



Often people in positions of responsibility need to juggle their roles in private and public relationships. This may lead to conflicts between the two roles.

Conflict of interest is a situation in which a person, such as a public official, an employee, or a professional, has a private or personal interest sufficient to appear to influence the objective exercise of his or her official duties.

Self Dealing: Using one's official government position to secure a contract to a private firm one owns.

Accepting Benefits: Bribery or substantial gifts.

Peddling Influence: The professional soliciting benefits in exchange for using his influence to unfairly advance the interests of a particular party.

CONFLICT OF INTEREST



Using Official Property for Personal Gratification: Using official vehicle for personal use.

Using Confidential Information: Using the information one gain to one's own advantage.

Outside Employment: A government doctor setting up private practice or one setting up own business that competes with one's current employer.

Post-Employment: A person who resigns from public or private employment and goes into business in the same area.

*Efforts have been made by various governments and organisations to **define core values** to be followed by public servants.*



DWIGHT WALDO

According to **Dwight Waldo**, an American political scientist, **civil servants** must take into account **12 obligations**.



LORD NOLAN

They are – **obligation to**: the constitution; the law; the nation and country; democracy; the rules of bureaucratic organization; the profession and professionalism; family and friends; personal groups; come in contact with local; the public interest or general welfare; humanity and world; God or religion.

In 1994, the UK government established a **Committee on Standards in Public Life**, chaired by Lord Nolan, to make recommendations to improve standards of behaviour in public life. The first report of the committee established **the seven principles of public life**, also known as the **“Nolan principles”**.

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

1

SELFLESSNESS

2

INTEGRITY

3

OBJECTIVITY

4

ACCOUNTABILITY

NOLAN PRINCIPLES

7

LEADERSHIP

6

HONESTY

5

OPENNESS

NOLAN PRINCIPLES

1 SELFLESSNESS

Should **act solely in terms of the public interest**. They should not do so in order to gain financial or other benefits for themselves, their family or their friends.

2 INTEGRITY

Should **not place themselves under any financial or other obligation** to outside individuals or organisations that might seek to influence them in the performance of their official duties.

3 OBJECTIVITY

In carrying out public business, including making public appointments, awarding contracts, or recommending individuals for rewards and benefits, holders of public office **should make choices on merit**.

Integrity: the quality of being honest and having strong moral principles that you refuse to change

Objectivity: the fact of being based on facts and not influenced by personal beliefs or feelings

4 ACCOUNTABILITY

Are **accountable** for their decisions and actions to the **public** and must submit themselves to whatever scrutiny is appropriate to their office.

5 OPENNESS

Should be **as open as possible** about all the decisions and actions that they take. They should give reasons for their decisions and restrict information only when the wider public interest clearly demands.

6 HONESTY

Have a duty to declare any private interests relating to their **public duties** and to take steps to resolve any conflicts arising in a way that protects the public interest.

7 LEADERSHIP

Should **promote and support** these principles by leadership and example.

OECD (Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development) also came up with '**Principles for Managing Ethics in the Public Service**'.

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